

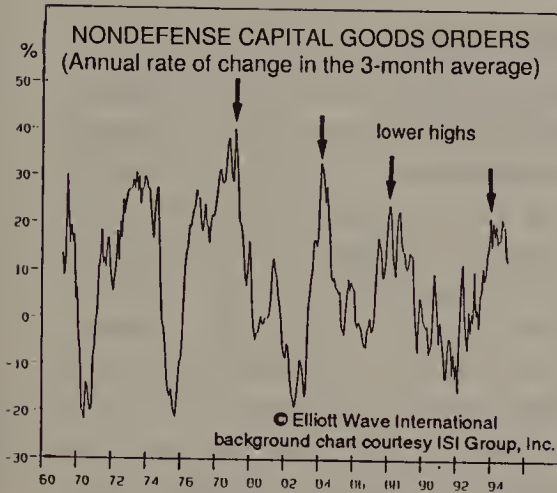


Figure 13-16

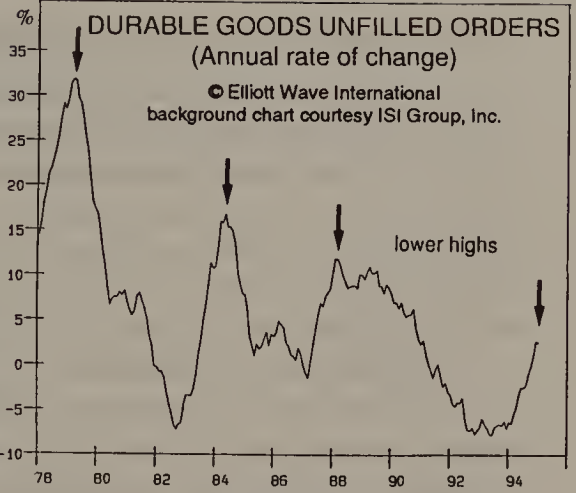


Figure 13-17

Figure 13-18 shows sales relative to business inventory, which is a highly sensitive reflection of economic activity. Notice the dates of the prior highest levels: 1955, 1959, 1966, 1973 and 1979-80. Every one of these times immediately preceded a downturn in stocks, which preceded a recession. In every case but one (1966), a recession hit the following year. As you can see, the ratio has just reached its highest level in at least forty years.

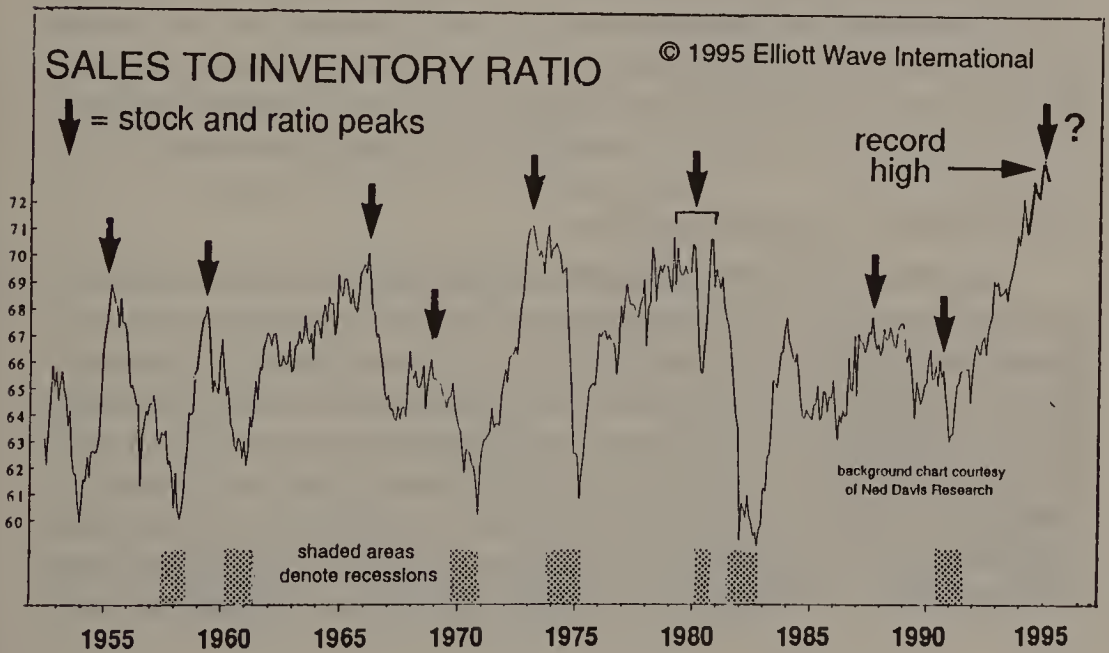


Figure 13-18